

INVESTOR CHARTER

Depositories — NSDL & CDSL

Vision • Mission • Investor Services • Grievance Redressal • Rights & Responsibilities

This document organizes the supplied Investor Charter material into a structured investor-facing reference.

1. Vision

- Towards making Indian Securities Market - Transparent, Efficient, & Investor friendly by providing safe, reliable, transparent and trusted record keeping platform for investors to hold and transfer securities in dematerialized form.

2. Mission

- To hold securities of investors in dematerialised form and facilitate their transfer, while ensuring safekeeping of securities and protecting interest of investors.
- To provide timely and accurate information to investors with regard to their holding and transfer of securities held by them.
- To provide the highest standards of investor education, investor awareness and timely services so as to enhance Investor Protection and create awareness about Investor Rights.

3. Business Transacted by the Depository and Depository Participant (DP)

A Depository is an organization which holds securities of investors in electronic form. Depositories provide services to Exchanges, Clearing Corporations, Depository Participants (DPs), Issuers and Investors in both primary and secondary markets. The depository carries out its activities through agents known as Depository Participants (DP).

Reference: <https://nsdl.co.in/dpsch.php>

4. Services Provided by Depositories Through Depository Participants

4.1 Basic Services

Sr. No.	Activity / Service	Expected Timeline
1	Dematerialization of securities	7 days
2	Rematerialization of securities	7 days
3	Mutual Fund Conversion / Destatementization	5 days
4	Re-conversion / Restatementisation of Mutual Fund units	7 days
5	Transmission of securities	7 days
6	Registering pledge request	15 days
7	Closure of demat account	30 days
8	Settlement Instruction	Physical DIS for pay-in up to 4 p.m. and electronic DIS up to 6 p.m. on T+1 day

4.2 Special / Value-Added Services

- Basic Services Demat Account (BSDA)
- Transposition cum dematerialization

- Linkages with Clearing System
- Distribution of cash and non-cash corporate benefits
- Pledge and hypothecation related services
- Internet-based services

4.3 Consolidated Account Statement (CAS)

CAS is issued 10 days from the end of the month if there were transactions in the previous month, or half yearly if there were no transactions.

4.4 Digitalization of Depository Services

- E-account opening
- Online instructions for execution
- e-DIS / Demat Gateway
- e-CAS facility
- Miscellaneous services

5. Grievance Redressal Mechanism

5.1 Process of Investor Grievance Redressal

Investors can lodge complaints/grievances against the Depository or Depository Participant through the following channels:

- SCORES — SEBI's web-based centralized grievance redressal system.
- The respective Depository's dedicated complaint-filing web portal.
- Designated email IDs of the Depository.

Complaints/grievances lodged directly with the Depository shall be resolved within 30 days.

5.2 Investor Grievance Redressal Committee (GRC)

If no amicable resolution is arrived at, the investor has the option to refer the complaint/grievance to the Grievance Redressal Committee of the Depository. The GRC will endeavor to resolve the matter by hearing the parties and examining necessary information and documents.

5.3 Arbitration Proceedings

The investor may avail the arbitration mechanism set out in the Byelaws and Business Rules/Operating Instructions of the Depository for a grievance or dispute relating to depository services. The arbitration reference shall be concluded through an arbitral award within 4 months from the date of appointment of arbitrator(s).

6. Special Circumstances — Termination of Depository Participant

Depositories may terminate participation where a participant no longer meets eligibility criteria and/or on other grounds mentioned in the bye-laws, such as suspension of a trading member by stock exchanges. A participant may also surrender participation by its own wish.

Investor protection:

- The client has the right to transfer all securities to another Participant of choice without charges for the transfer within 30 days from the date of intimation by letter/email.

7. Dos and Don'ts for Investors

1. Always deal with a SEBI registered Depository Participant for opening a demat account.
2. Read all documents carefully before signing them.
3. Before granting Power of Attorney to operate your demat account to an intermediary such as a Stock Broker or PMS, carefully examine the scope and implications of the powers granted.
4. Always make payments to registered intermediaries through banking channels. Do not make payments in the name of an employee of the intermediary.
5. Accept the DIS book only from your DP, keep it safe, and never sign or issue blank or partially filled DIS slips. Accurately mention ISIN and number of securities; strike out blank spaces and ensure corrections/cancellations are properly initialled/signed.
6. Inform changes in personal information linked to the demat account and obtain confirmation of updation.
7. Provide your mobile number and email ID in the account opening form to receive SMS alerts and updates.
8. Ensure the mobile number and email ID linked to the demat account remain correctly updated.
9. Do not share passwords for online trading or demat accounts.
10. Do not share OTPs received from banks, brokers or other service providers.
11. Do not share login credentials for depository e-facilities such as e-DIS/demat gateway, SPEED-e/easiest, etc.
12. Demat is mandatory for transfer of securities of listed public limited companies, subject to specified exceptions.

- 13.** If you have a demat-account grievance, contact the designated Depository email IDs or lodge it with SEBI through SCORES.
- 14.** Keep records of documents signed, DIS issued and account statements received.
- 15.** Carefully verify transaction statements for all debits and credits. Report unauthorized debits or credits to the DP or Depository.
- 16.** Appoint a nominee to facilitate heirs in obtaining securities after completion of necessary procedures.
- 17.** Register for the Depository's internet facility or use its mobile application to monitor holdings.
- 18.** Ensure holding and transaction statements are received periodically as instructed. The supplied material states that investors are entitled to a transaction statement every month if they have transactions.
- 19.** Do not follow herd mentality for investments. Seek expert and professional advice.
- 20.** Beware of assured/fixed returns.

8. Rights of Investors

1. Receive a copy of KYC and account-opening documents.
2. No minimum balance is required to be maintained in a demat account.
3. No charges are payable for opening a demat account.
4. If executed, receive a copy of the Power of Attorney. Power of Attorney is not a mandatory requirement as per SEBI / Stock Exchanges, and the investor has the right to revoke an authorization at any time.
5. Open more than one demat account in the same name with a single DP or multiple DPs.
6. Receive statements of account periodically and raise discrepancies with the DP immediately; if the DP does not respond, approach the Depository.
7. Create pledge and/or other interest or encumbrance on demat holdings.
8. Give standing instructions regarding crediting of securities to the demat account.
9. Exercise the right to freeze/defreeze the demat account or specific securities/specific quantities maintained with the DP.
10. Approach the Participant, Depository or SEBI for grievance resolution within prescribed timelines.
11. Eligible investor shareholders have a right to cast votes on company resolutions through the internet-based e-Voting platform developed by Depositories.
12. Receive information about charges and fees. Agreed charges/tariffs shall not increase unless written notice of at least 30 days is given to the investor.

9. Responsibilities of Investors

1. Deal with a SEBI registered DP for opening a demat account, KYC and Depository activities.
2. Provide complete documents for account opening and KYC. Fill required details in the Account Opening/KYC form and cancel blank fields.
3. Read all documents and conditions before signing the account opening form.
4. Accept the DIS book only from the DP, keep it in safe custody, and do not sign or issue blank or partially filled DIS.
5. Accurately mention details such as ISIN and number of securities.
6. Inform changes in information linked to the demat account and obtain confirmation of updation.
7. Regularly verify balances and demat statements and reconcile them with trades/transactions.
8. Appoint nominee(s) to facilitate heirs in obtaining securities in their demat account.
9. Do not fall prey to fraudsters sending emails/SMSs promising huge profits from trading in stocks/securities.

10. IPF Policy

The supplied charter provides the following IPF Policy reference: <https://nsdl.co.in/downloadables/pdf/Policy.pdf>

Official / Reference Links Mentioned in the Supplied Material

- SCORES: <https://www.scores.gov.in/scores/Welcome.html>
- NSDL Depository Participant information: <https://nsdl.co.in/dpsch.php>
- NSDL complaint portal: <https://www.epass.nsdl.com/complaints/websitecomplaints.aspx>

Source note: This PDF has been organized from the supplied Investor Charter content. The wording and timelines have been preserved in substance; information not supplied in detail has not been independently reconstructed.

